



MOOD CHANGES DURING PERIMENOPAUSE

Understanding Emotional Changes Before Menopause

Perimenopause is the stage of life before menopause, usually beginning in a person's 40s or early 50s. During this time, hormone levels change as the body gradually transitions toward the end of menstrual cycles.

While many people recognize physical symptoms such as hot flashes and irregular periods, emotional and mental health changes can also occur during perimenopause.

Why Mood Changes Happen

Hormonal changes during perimenopause can affect how the brain regulates emotions. Fluctuations in hormones like estrogen and progesterone may influence mood, energy levels, and sleep patterns.

Life circumstances during this stage may also contribute to stress.

Common Emotional Symptoms

These symptoms may include:

- Irritability or mood swings
- Low energy or fatigue
- Feeling tearful or emotional
- Difficulty concentrating
- Trouble sleeping

Unlike PMS, mood symptoms during perimenopause may occur at any time and may not follow a monthly cycle.

Depression and Anxiety

Symptoms of depression may include:

- Persistent sadness or hopelessness
- Loss of interest in normal activities
- Feeling emotionally numb
- Difficulty sleeping or concentrating

Some people may also experience anxiety, which can involve constant worrying, tension, sweating, or nausea.

Ways to Support Mental Well-Being

- Maintain a consistent sleep schedule
- Limit caffeine and sugar
- Exercise regularly
- Practice relaxation techniques
- Reduce stress through hobbies, journaling, or music

When to Seek Help

If mood changes become severe or interfere with daily life, speak with a healthcare provider. Doctors may recommend:

- Counseling
- Mental health support
- Medication
- Hormone therapy in some cases

Key Takeaway

Perimenopause is a natural stage of life that can bring both physical and emotional changes. Mood symptoms such as irritability, anxiety, or depression are common during

this time, but support and treatment options are available.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. Mood Changes During Perimenopause Are Real. Here's What to Know.